This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the supply of Nicotine Replacement Therapy (Patches and Oral Products) for the treatment of Smoking Cessation

Patient Group Direction, version 005, issued 30 September 2026. Supersedes Version 004, 14 September 2026.

Owner and authorising organisation: Get Real Health Limited, company number 12744898, registered office Zenvite Health Unit 23, St. Asaph Business Park, St. Asaph, Denbighshire, LL17 0LJ. This Patient Group Direction is authorised on behalf of Get Real Health Limited by its Medical Director and its Head Pharmacist, whose signatures for this version are on the authorisation page at the end of the document. It applies to the registered healthcare professionals named under it by a pharmacy or clinic that has adopted it through a Get Real Health service agreement, at the premises stated in that adoption, and to no other organisation.

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Smoking Cessation

Overview

- Smoking is the leading preventable cause of death
- Nicotine dependence is a chronic relapsing condition
- Pharmacotherapy (varenicline, NRT, bupropion) doubles quit rates compared to placebo

Assessment

- Fagerström score to assess nicotine dependence
- Assess readiness to quit and motivation
- Set a quit date (typically 1-2 weeks from assessment)
- Review previous quit attempts and reasons for relapse
- Screen for contraindications and red flags

Management

- NRT is effective first-line therapy for smoking cessation
- Combination NRT (patch plus short-acting oral product) is more effective than single product
- Combine with structured behavioural support for optimal outcomes
- Follow-up at 2 weeks, 4 weeks, then monthly during treatment

Red Flags

- **Psychiatric history:** Depression, anxiety disorder, psychosis - monitor mood throughout treatment
- **Cardiovascular disease:** Recent MI (within 4 weeks), unstable angina, severe arrhythmias - assess benefit vs risk
- **Skin disorders:** Generalised skin conditions may affect patch absorption

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Nicotine 24-hour patches 7mg, 14mg, 21mg (NiQuitin Clear)

for the treatment of

Smoking Cessation

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must have completed training in working under Patient Group Directions, for example the CPPE PGD e-learning and e-assessment or an equivalent, and have been assessed as competent to work under a PGD before first working under this one; previous experience of working under a PGD is not required • All users should complete the Get Real Health training for this PGD before first working under it, or have completed equivalent training elsewhere, for example another provider's training for the same service or substantial recent experience of delivering it under a PGD, and must read this PGD in full before first working under it. The date the training was completed, and for equivalent training what it was, is to be recorded in the Get Real Health training record or in the

	employing organisation's own training record. The employing organisation remains responsible for being satisfied that each practitioner it authorises under this PGD is competent to do so. • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Smoking cessation in adults aged 18 years and over who are motivated to quit smoking
Inclusion criteria	Age 18 years and over Motivated to quit smoking and set a quit date Capacity and willingness to provide informed consent
Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to nicotine or excipients Generalised skin disorders that may affect absorption Non-smokers or occasional smokers
Cautions	Cardiovascular disease: recent MI (within 4 weeks), unstable angina, severe arrhythmias (assess benefit vs risk) Diabetes (monitor blood glucose control; nicotine may affect insulin requirements) Phaeochromocytoma (nicotine may cause catecholamine release) Hepatic/renal impairment (consider close monitoring) Peptic ulcer disease (nicotine may increase gastric acid secretion) Pregnancy (use only if unable to quit without NRT; benefits must outweigh risks) Breastfeeding (nicotine passes into breast milk; weigh risks and benefits)
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Nicotine 24-hour transdermal patches 7mg, 14mg, 21mg (NiQuitin Clear). Nicorette Invisi patches are 16-hour patches of 10mg, 15mg and 25mg and are not the product described here.
Legal category	P/GSL depending on pack size
Storage	Below 25°C. Protect from moisture and direct sunlight. Keep in original packaging.
Route/method of administration	Transdermal, applied to clean, dry, hairless skin. Rotate application sites daily.
Dose and frequency	Heavy smokers (>10 cigarettes/day): Start 21mg/24-hour patch daily for 6-8 weeks, then 14mg for 2 weeks, then 7mg for 2 weeks Lighter smokers (≤10 cigarettes/day): Start 14mg/24-hour patch daily for 6 weeks, then 7mg for 2 weeks (NiQuitin Clear SmPC) Total course: 8-12 weeks depending on dependence Application: Apply to clean, dry, hairless area (arm or chest). Rotate sites daily to minimize irritation. Press firmly for 10 seconds.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	Up to 28 patches per supply (4-week supply). Repeat supplies under this PGD only after the scheduled review, and not beyond the 8 to 12 week course total.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	8-12 weeks. Review at 2 weeks, 4 weeks, then regularly.
Adverse effects	Common: Application site reactions (erythema, burning, itching, swelling); headache; dizziness; insomnia; vivid dreams; palpitations Common: Gastrointestinal disturbance; nausea Uncommon: Rash; urticaria; tachycardia Note: Skin reactions may persist for hours after patch removal

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied

	• advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken • that the medicine was supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: • Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the Patient Information Leaflet (PIL) for each nicotine product supplied. The patch arm and the oral-product arm of this document may be used together as combination therapy; counsel on the technique for each product supplied. Discuss the treatment plan, correct usage technique, and importance of combining with behavioural support.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Correct technique is essential: Patches must be applied to clean, dry, hairless skin and sites rotated daily. For gum: chew slowly then park between cheek and gum. For lozenges: dissolve in mouth, do not chew. Combine NRT with behavioural support (smoking cessation counselling, NHS Stop Smoking Services) for best results Combination therapy: Using a patch with short-acting oral product (gum/lozenges) is more effective than either alone Use enough NRT: If you continue to crave cigarettes, you may need higher doses or combination therapy Do not smoke while using NRT: Continued smoking increases nicotine levels and risk of adverse effects Continue NRT for the full 8-12 weeks: Do not stop early even if abstinence is achieved Withdrawal symptoms: Expect cravings and withdrawal symptoms; these usually improve within 2-3 weeks For patches: Remove old patch before applying new one. Dispose of safely (fold with sticky side in). Mild skin redness is normal. For oral products: Do not eat or drink for 15 minutes before and during use. Avoid acidic drinks (coffee, fruit juice) which reduce nicotine absorption. Monitor blood glucose more frequently if diabetic (nicotine may affect insulin requirements) Avoid driving or operating machinery if experiencing dizziness

	Cardiovascular symptoms: Seek immediate medical attention if experiencing chest pain, palpitations, or shortness of breath Report severe skin reactions or oral irritation to your healthcare provider Inform healthcare provider immediately if pregnant or planning pregnancy Attend follow-up appointments at 2 weeks, 4 weeks, and monthly to monitor progress

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources
- NICE CKS Guidance: Smoking Cessation
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature

Valid from date	Expiry date		
30/9/26	31/7/27		

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service. To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These are the adopting organisation's own signatories and must not be Get Real Health staff.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Change history to version 001

Later versions are recorded in the Version and change record at the end of this document.

Version number	**Change details**	**Date**
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Nicotine oral products (2mg and 4mg lozenges or gum)

for the treatment of

Smoking Cessation

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must have completed training in working under Patient Group Directions, for example the CPPE PGD e-learning and e-assessment or an equivalent, and have been assessed as competent to work under a PGD before first working under this one; previous experience of working under a PGD is not required • All users should complete the Get Real Health training for this PGD before first working under it, or have completed equivalent training elsewhere, for example another provider's training for the same service or substantial recent experience of delivering it under a PGD, and must read this PGD in full before first working under it. The date the training was completed, and for equivalent training what it was, is to be recorded in the Get Real Health training record or in the employing organisation's own training record. The employing organisation remains responsible for being satisfied that each practitioner it authorises under this PGD is competent to do so. • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products

	• All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Smoking cessation in adults aged 18 years and over who are motivated to quit smoking
Inclusion criteria	Age 18 years and over Motivated to quit smoking and set a quit date Capacity and willingness to provide informed consent
Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to nicotine or excipients Non-smokers or occasional smokers
Cautions	Cardiovascular disease: recent MI (within 4 weeks), unstable angina, severe arrhythmias (assess benefit vs risk) Diabetes (monitor blood glucose control; nicotine may affect insulin requirements) Phaeochromocytoma (nicotine may cause catecholamine release) Hepatic/renal impairment (consider close monitoring) Peptic ulcer disease (nicotine may increase gastric acid secretion) Oral ulceration or dental work (nicotine products may cause irritation) Pregnancy (use only if unable to quit without NRT; benefits must outweigh risks) Breastfeeding (nicotine passes into breast milk; weigh risks and benefits)
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Nicotine lozenges or gum 2mg and 4mg
Legal category	P/GSL
Storage	Below 25°C. Keep in original packaging. Protect from moisture.
Route/method of administration	Oral. Gum: chew slowly, then park between cheek and gum. Lozenges: dissolve slowly in mouth.

Dose and frequency	For those smoking ≤20 cigarettes/day: Use 2mg lozenge/gum For those smoking >20 cigarettes/day: Use 4mg lozenge/gum Initial use: 8-12 pieces/day, reduce gradually over 8-12 weeks Gum technique: Chew slowly, then park between gum and cheek. Repeat chewing when flavour fades. Lozenge technique: Place in mouth and allow to dissolve slowly. Do not chew or swallow whole. Duration: 8-12 weeks total
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	Up to 120 pieces per supply (about 2 weeks at 8 to 12 pieces a day). Repeat supplies under this PGD only after the scheduled review, and not beyond the 8 to 12 week course total.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	8-12 weeks. Review at 2 weeks, 4 weeks, then regularly.
Adverse effects	Common: Mouth and throat irritation; hiccups; gastrointestinal discomfort; jaw ache (gum); headache; nausea Uncommon: Palpitations; tachycardia Note: Oral symptoms usually diminish with continued use

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied • advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken • that the medicine was supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: • Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the Patient Information Leaflet (PIL) for each nicotine product supplied. The patch arm and the oral-product arm of this document may be used together as combination therapy; counsel on the technique for each product supplied. Discuss the treatment plan, correct usage technique, and importance of combining with behavioural support.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Correct technique is essential: Patches must be applied to clean, dry, hairless skin and sites rotated daily. For gum: chew slowly then park between cheek and gum. For lozenges: dissolve in mouth, do not chew. Combine NRT with behavioural support (smoking cessation counselling, NHS Stop Smoking Services) for best results Combination therapy: Using a patch with short-acting oral product (gum/lozenges) is more effective than either alone Use enough NRT: If you continue to crave cigarettes, you may need higher doses or combination therapy Do not smoke while using NRT: Continued smoking increases nicotine levels and risk of adverse effects Continue NRT for the full 8-12 weeks: Do not stop early even if abstinence is achieved Withdrawal symptoms: Expect cravings and withdrawal symptoms; these usually improve within 2-3 weeks For patches: Remove old patch before applying new one. Dispose of safely (fold with sticky side in). Mild skin redness is normal. For oral products: Do not eat or drink for 15 minutes before and during use. Avoid acidic drinks (coffee, fruit juice) which reduce nicotine absorption. Monitor blood glucose more frequently if diabetic (nicotine may affect insulin requirements) Avoid driving or operating machinery if experiencing dizziness Cardiovascular symptoms: Seek immediate medical attention if experiencing chest pain, palpitations, or shortness of breath Report severe skin reactions or oral irritation to your healthcare provider Inform healthcare provider immediately if pregnant or planning pregnancy Attend follow-up appointments at 2 weeks, 4 weeks, and monthly to monitor progress

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017

https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2

- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources
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Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date	Expiry date		
30/9/26	31/7/27		

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service. To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These are the adopting organisation's own signatories and must not be Get Real Health staff.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Change history to version 001

Later versions are recorded in the Version and change record at the end of this document.

Version number	**Change details**	**Date**
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025

Version and change record

Version: v005

Issued: 30 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 004, 14 September 2026

Valid from: 30 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Training before first use, applied to every Get Real Health PGD on 30 September 2026: the staff section now states that each practitioner should complete the Get Real Health training for this PGD, or equivalent training elsewhere, before first working under it, must read the PGD in full before first use, and that the date of completion is recorded. Training is recorded; it is not a condition of access, and the employing organisation remains responsible for being satisfied of competence. No clinical content changes.

Previous version records

Version: v004

Issued: 14 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 003, 11 September 2026

Valid from: 14 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Identity and training, applied to every Get Real Health PGD on 14 September 2026 after two adopting pharmacies wrote: the Get Real Health logo is in the page header; the organisation that owns and authorises this direction, Get Real Health Limited, is named under the strapline with its company number and registered office; the requirement that practitioners must previously have used a PGD is replaced by a requirement for PGD training and a competence assessment, so that a newly registered pharmacist or technician who has completed the training may work under it; and the earlier change history table is headed with the versions it covers.

Previous version records

Version: v003

Issued: 11 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 002, 11 September 2026

Valid from: 11 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

Changes in this version:

Cover title corrected from administration to supply; NRT is supplied.

Patch arm title and medicine row: e.g. removed so the 24-hour arm names NiQuitin Clear only, as the v002 change record states.

Patch dose row: the lighter-smoker step-down is stated (14mg for 6 weeks then 7mg for 2 weeks, per the NiQuitin Clear SmPC).

Patch quantity row: 28 patches is stated as a per-supply maximum with repeat supplies only after review and within the course total.

Oral quantity row: the 120-piece maximum is kept and the 4-week description corrected to about 2 weeks at the stated daily use; repeat supplies only after review.

Written information row (both arms): states that the two arms may be used together as combination therapy and that counselling covers each product supplied.

Records row: the two run-together bullets were separated and punctuated (date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied; adverse reactions and actions taken; supplied via PGD).

Records row: the under-18 record-retention bullet was removed because this PGD does not treat anyone under 18.

Wording corrections from the tool alignment and adversarial review of the consultation tools, 11 September 2026. Each correction resolves a contradiction inside the document or a plain error, taking the safer reading; no indication is widened, no dose raised and no exclusion removed. Questions that need a clinical decision are recorded separately and are not changed here.

Previous version records

Version: v002

Issued: 11 September 2026

Supersedes: Version 001, 1 November 2025

Valid from: 11 September 2026. Expiry: 31 July 2027. These dates govern this version and supersede any earlier date printed elsewhere in this document.

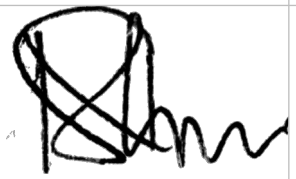
Changes in this version:

Product naming corrected: Nicorette patches are 16-hour patches (10, 15, 25 mg) and were wrongly listed as an example of a 24-hour 7/14/21 mg patch. The 24-hour arm now names NiQuitin only.

Structural clean-up applied to every live Get Real Health PGD on 11 September 2026, following the adversarial review of 10 September: the adopting pharmacy's authorisation block is blank, for the pharmacy's own signatories; one signed authorisation page for this version replaces the earlier signature blocks; every validity cell states this version's dates (valid from 11 September 2026, expiry 31 July 2027); narration about earlier versions, the consultation tool and individual customers is removed from the body of the document; the change records of earlier reissues are carried below as previous version records. No clinical criterion changes unless listed.

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Version v005, 30 September 2026.

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Director GMC: 6047293		30 September 2026
Chris Pilkington	Head Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		30 September 2026

Both authorising signatories reviewed this version together on 30 September 2026 and gave their authorisation for it to be issued. Signatures were applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs. This version is not valid without both signatures.